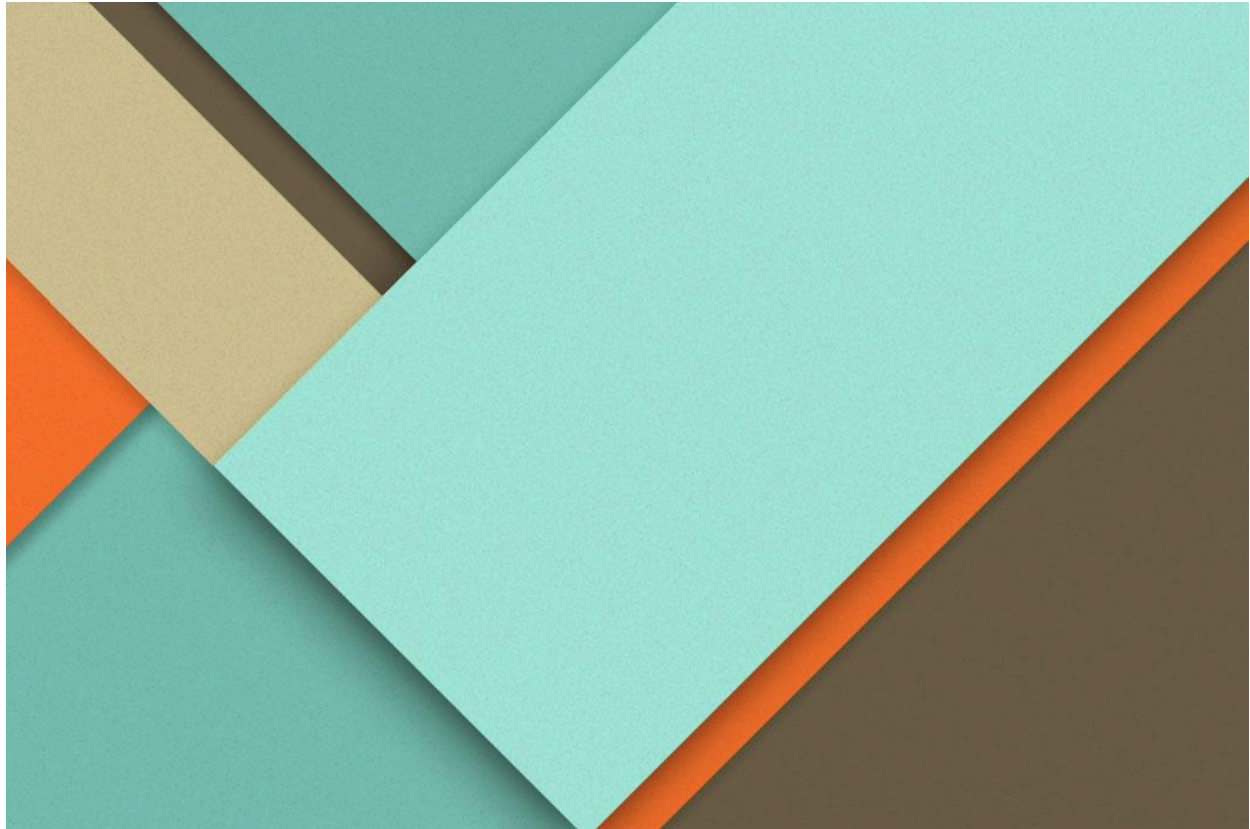




G13 HACKATHON GROUP 8

19 June 2026

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Problem Statement

South Africa faces a compounding systemic crisis in copper cable, theft and crime fuel and amplify one another.

Solution

The problem cannot be solved by addressing any single node. A technical solution that hardens infrastructure without reducing cable theft. The solution is to combat cable theft in communities, our solution is hardware and software based and they work in tandem with each other. With hardware monitoring (grid sensors, fibre break detection, tamper alerts), software intelligence (predictive patrol deployment, integrated evidence management) and institutional coordination (cross-agency data sharing between SAPS, municipalities, Eskom). Our solution is an integrated governance architecture capable of operating across hardware, software, institutional, and social layers simultaneously, at the speed and scale the crisis demands.

Impact

The question is who it will impact, it should be who wouldn't it impact? Our systems take into consideration Eskom, metro clusters and municipalities having visually impaired people that also need to work this system seamlessly and flawlessly. If we stop cable theft, the domino effect doesn't have a choice but to follow.

Milestones

Three month phasing plan

Month 1

Foundation: Create the core data model, incident logging UI. The scrap registry goes live with manual input.

Month 2

Integration: Eskom status feed and use existing smart meter estates.

Month 3

Pilot: SAPS CAS export. Pilot with one metro SAPS cluster and one municipality.